

Andrew Sykes

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Location: Macclesfield, SK9

Profile

A self-motivated professional with extensive experience in the printing industry, contributing significantly to the growth and success of a family business. Proficient in mastering a wide range of disciplines within the sector, with a particular focus on adapting to and leveraging technological advancements during the transition to a fully digital workflow. Demonstrates exceptional attention to detail in all roles, including the mentorship of new recruits, and a commitment to continuous self-improvement in print design and web development.

Professional Work History

Job seeking, Interrupted

2020 – 2024

- Dedicated time to exploring contemporary tools and technologies in web development.
- Acknowledged the transformative impact of digital advancements on traditional industries, embracing continuous learning to adapt to evolving professional demands.
- Maintained enthusiasm and resilience, embodying the belief that progress is achieved through persistence and adaptability.

Refactoring

2015 – 2019

- Following the sale of the family business in 2014, focused on upgrading skills in web development.
- Undertook freelance print projects for former clients and volunteered expertise when required.
- Enhanced knowledge of object-oriented programming principles, design patterns, and programming paradigms by refactoring earlier web projects initiated at North Wolds Printers.

North Wolds Printers Ltd

Pre-Press Director | Digital Press Operator

1999 – 2014

- Oversaw the implementation of imagesetters, regaining control of digital output.
- Mastered the Apogee Pre-Press workflow software, crucial to a significant department upgrade.
- Researched and evaluated digital print and finishing technologies to enhance service offerings.
- Exploited digital printing's potential by introducing variable data printing solutions.
- Operated the Konica Minolta c6501 digital press with integrated saddle-stitch finishing.
- Utilised SQL and JavaScript skills to prepare files for variable data printing.

North Wolds Printers Ltd
Pre-Press Manager | Mac Operator

1993 – 1998

- Spearheaded the integration of digital equipment into the pre-press department.
 - Implemented rigorous pre-flighting routines to ensure flawless digital output.
 - Delivered design solutions for print clients using industry-standard software, including QuarkXPress, Freehand, Photoshop, Illustrator, and InDesign.
 - Advocated for and introduced PDF workflows as a reliable solution for maintaining file integrity during iSDN transfers.
 - Guided investment decisions in hardware, software, and personnel to support the transition from traditional to digital processes.
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Skills

- Expertise in traditional and digital print production workflows.
 - Advanced proficiency in design software: QuarkXPress, Freehand, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign.
 - Strong programming knowledge: SQL, JavaScript, object-oriented programming, and design patterns.
 - Experienced in pre-press and post-press processes, including imposition, variable data printing, and finishing techniques.
 - Excellent mentoring and leadership skills, fostering team development and operational excellence.
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Education and Professional Development

- Extensive self-taught expertise in web development, focusing on modern programming practices and design principles.
 - Continuous learning of evolving technologies and industry advancements to remain competitive and skilled.
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References

Available upon request.

Github

<https://knavesmireboy.github.io/cv/>